

Popular Open Source Databases: An Overview

An open source database offers a codebase that is available for users to freely download, modify, distribute, and reuse. In this article, we will take a brief look at a few popular database systems that are open source.



In recent years, many database systems have appeared in the market, offering organisations a wide range of options. These databases are from reliable companies such as Oracle, Microsoft, SAP and IBM. Databases from newcomers in this field, such as Google, Amazon and Rackspace, are also getting very popular.

MySQL is the oldest open source database management system. Since then, many new systems have come into the market, while older solutions such as MySQL are being developed further.

Why consider an open source database?

Many organisations still store data outside their enterprise database platforms, due to which there are continuous risks of data security and the availability of support to critical business operations. Integrating these data sources into commercial databases may not be possible due to technical or cost factors. Open source databases provide a robust data management platform without the upfront costs associated with running a commercial database, and the negotiations needed when there is a price increase.

Also, the cost of commercial database platforms may be out of reach for small

businesses and startups. Open source databases offer a rich database with a very low-level entry price to develop applications that can scale to support large user communities and workloads.

The most attractive feature of such software is that users can modify it by changing its source code according to their preferences, using very less programming language.

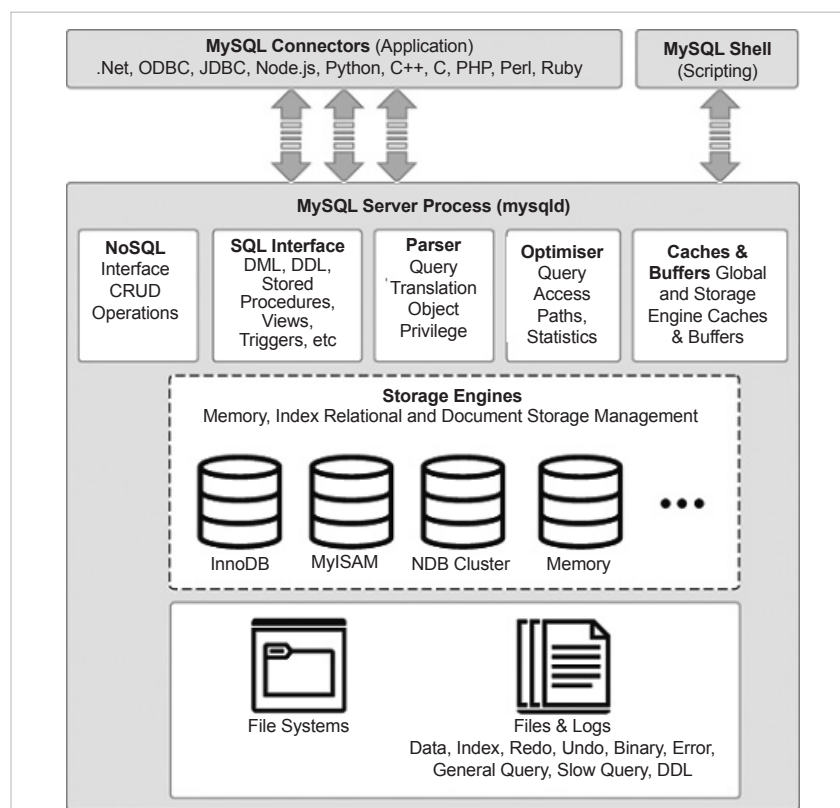


Figure 1: MySQL architecture with pluggable storage engines (Reference: <https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/8.0/en/pluggable-storage-overview.html>)